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How to set up a Bitcoin miner

25 comments | Antonio Madeira | 12 Feb 2015 | 325.65 k

Setting up a Bitcoin miner can be quite a complex task. But with a bit of effort and time it should be easy to get the hang of.

(Alternatively, you can also buy a cloud mining contract with Hashflare or Genesis Mining.)

If you have chosen a mining rig through using our guide and calculator then most of the hard work is done.

If you've bought the rig as an off the shelf product ready to go then it should be as easy as plugging it in and choosing a mining pool to join. Your wallet should be hooked up too all ready to run.

If your rig or FGPA or graphics card is not ready to run then you need to do a quick few steps – which can take a bit of time.

> **Step 1:** Download the full Bitcoin client. This can take quite a few days depending on your download speed.
>
> **Step 2:** Then you need to download some Bitcoin mining software – or the programme that tells your mining hardware how to run.
>
> **Step 3:** Choose a mining pool otherwise you might end up with a long time before solving your first block.

If you have ordered a miner that comes with a predefined method of connecting to the network the process can sometimes be quite difficult. For example the Antminer U3 63 GH can be quite tricky to get up and running as it requires you to download drivers and run CGMiner yourself – later versions of CGMiner have reduced the complexity of this process.

With the BitMain Antminer S1, S2 & S3 there are also some difficult steps to be followed – mostly to do with defining IP addresses and switching IP address protocols which can mean logging into your own router to find out what address the miner has been signed (quite daunting for some) – with instructions assuming a high level of knowledge by the user with a lot of basic information lost in translation.

However in terms of simplicity Spondoolies tech is probably the most user friendly in terms of set up. Miners such as the SP20 and SP10 can be plugged into your router, and after following five sets of simple and clear instructions can be up and running in five minutes.

Another key point to remember is the power supply you are using. Some miners come with their own internal power supplies, whilst some have to be bought external PSU (power Supply Units). These units have to be bought with the requisite power to coincide with that of the mining chips. For example the Spondoolies tech SP20 needs 1200 Watts of power with a 10-20% margin – so two corsair 750W PSU's will be more than ample.

It is also important to remember that you need to complete the circuit on standard PSU units - although this can sound and look dangerous or scary it is in fact a very low risk and simple operation.

All you need to do is complete the circuit for the PSU allow electricity to flow – and as they were designed to power motherboards this means tricking the PSU into thinking it is plugged in normally, or shorting the 24 pin motherboard attachment. Simply take the largest (24 pin connector) and put a paperclip from the green wire to any one of the black wires and you will have completed the circuit and the PSU will now switch on. The voltage is extremely low so there is no need of insulation or worry of electrocution if the wires are bare.

Also remember that if the unit you are buying doesn't come with a PSU this can become quite a significant part of the initial capital outlay. For example the SP20 in Dec 2014 could be bought for $500 with two corsair power supplies costing $200 dollars or so. When calculating your returns and investment metrics be sure to include your full costs.

Comments

What is your opinion on How to set up a Bitcoin miner? (You will be banned if you post affiliate / referral links. Please keep the conversation civilized and remember, we're all in this together!)

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2 years ago

I invested late last year with digital currency and my experience with them was nothing but awesome. It all began when I saw a lot of reveal how he had helped them made profit on bitcoin with the aid of his mining program, I had to reach out to him to help me too on his email (digitalcurrency14 @gmailcom) he explained the whole process to me and assure me he will help me after we both got a deal, long story cut short I started making 1.5btc every 10 days since we have started and this is the 6th time I've made a profit of 9btc. I cleared all debt on my credit report, get an apartment of my own and have the rest money save in bank as i'm currently waiting for my next profit to set up a business and get myself a car. This has been the greatest thing to ever happen to me in my life

1 reply Agree 1 1

regitom431
2 years ago

The crypto mining space is winding up progressively more marvelous as higher calculation power is used in mining. On the other hand you can take a chance and make easy profit on bitcoin, you need to join Digitalcurrency14@gmail com Bitcoin mining pool to mine adequately and make a lot of profit, all they do is to connect your blockchain to there mining pool and that way you'll make a lot of profit like I did. I don't really know how they get this done but there service is beyond Immagination. Connect to there Mining pool today and get yourself a better erning on bitcoin!

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2 years ago

edsd

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2 years ago

Thanks once again Digital Currency. You helped me out yet again. I had sent some BTC to myself from CoinbasePro to my Nano S. I went to Ledger Live to confirm that it had gotten there and it had NOT. I was wondering what could had happened, did I use the right address? Long story short, I found out that my bitcoin wallet had been hacked and the address was changed. I began to sweat wondering how I could get my 5 bitcoin back then I contact this bitcoin expert digitalcurrency14 @ gmail. com who taught me how to make profit on bitcoin few month ago I explained everything to him and he assured me he will help me out. He helped me recovered my 5 bitcoin back from the hacker, I couldn't believe my eye until I confirmed it on my wallet and it finally got to my Nano. Almost 2 weeks now and I'm still grateful. Thanks Digital Currency! I still make profit everyday on bitcoin with his help

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lynettewood14
2 years ago

I invested late last year with digital currency and my experience with them was nothing but awesome. It all began when I saw a lot of reveal how he had helped them made profit on bitcoin with the aid of his mining program, I had to reach out to him to help me too on his email (digitalcurrency14 @gmailcom) he explained the whole process to me and assure me he will help me after we both got a deal, long story cut short I started making 1.5btc every 10 days since we have started and this is the 6th time I've made a profit of 9btc. I cleared all debt on my credit report, get an apartment of my own and have the rest money save in bank as i'm currently waiting for my next profit to set up a business and get myself a car. This has been the greatest thing to ever happen to me in my life. I am highly indebted Digital currency!

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helluva32
3 years ago

Brain Food: Crypto can be mined from your phone,smartphone that is.... And the best part about it,all you got to do is monetary it....

TIPS:
*Don't mine too many at 1 time, it causes your phone to shut off or freeze.

* Use old phones,that way you can keep them on the charger

2 replies Agree 1

d3414d95ce
3 years ago

Oh, I just found that your phone can also mine crypto at The Crypto Sight: thecryptosight.com/electroneum-creates-smartphone-that-mines-crypto/

1 reply Agree 2

mail2ckr
4 years ago

What is the Power requirements for setting up new bit coin mining unit

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mostahkam.saleh
4 years ago

How can I change bitcoin to cash money?
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2 replies Agree 1

dabreprince
4 years ago

i have antminer s9 so what coin should i mine which coin is profitable

2 replies Agree 2

vjaybhaye180
4 years ago

Hello I Want to Mine BTC So Any One Can Help Me How Can Start PLZ

1 reply Agree

sierrafl97
4 years ago

I am trying to determine if a firewall is important when mining. It only makes sense. But then i ask myself - what specifically needs to be controlled? To make changes to the configuration of the mining machine, I need to connect directly to the same router as the machines. So what exactly needs to be protected? From there I expect I would then determine the hardware/software needed to successfully setup the firewall.

reply Agree

661FAB5C
4 years ago

hello i want to mine BTC so anyone can help me how can i start plz

2 replies Agree

cryptokiddos
5 years ago

I'm curious, how soon will the Antminer S9 be replaced/upgraded to a newer/faster unit? How long does the current chip technology have before it's challenged by a better one. Thoughts / ideas welcome!! Thanks

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2 replies

danielmccauley18
5 years ago

I'm already running an antminer s9 and I'm averaging 13.2 Th/s. My question is would I be able to run multiple miners together or would I need to run each miner as it's own unit?

9 replies | Agree 1

VladimirGranada
5 years ago

i have researched a little bit on genesis and the reviews are great. i find no negative approach on genesis. i have a question guys, i cannot afford to set up a high-end mining rig. i can only afford a 4gb Video Card 256bit ofcourse. with this video card, and with the help of genesis mining, am i ready to start mining?

4 replies | Agree 1 | 1

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